

Vasista Sandeep S

AVP, Program Management (Tech & Product)

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PROFILE

Executive technology leader and Six Sigma Black Belt with 14+ years scaling massive consumer platforms, engineering portfolios, and cross-functional organizations. Expert in bridging product strategy with engineering execution for high-volume streaming and commerce platforms (30M+ users). Proven track record of building 'Team of Teams' structures, managing multi-million-dollar roadmaps, and driving architectural transformations across OTT, Finance, and Retail. Passionate about leveraging GenAI and modern data stacks to drive business innovation.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Group Leadership:** Portfolio Management, Resource Planning, Budget Governance, Executive Reporting, Vendor Management, Cross-Functional Governance.
- Domain Expertise:** OTT / Streaming (SonyLIV), FinTech & Retail Commerce (Walmart), Personalization Engines, Identity Management (SSO), Data Privacy (GDPR).
- Technical Strategy:** Microservices Architecture, High-Availability Distributed Systems (99.99%), Cloud Architecture (AWS/Azure), GenAI Integrations, Load Testing Strategy.
- Tools:** Jira, BigPicture, Confluence, Python, SQL, Power BI, Tableau.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Sony Pictures Networks India** Mar 2026 - Present

AVP, Program Management (Tech & Product)

 - Organizational Leadership & Scale:** Direct the executive engineering portfolio and a cross-functional 'Team of Teams' to sustain 99.99% system availability during extreme live-traffic events (250K RPS) on the global SonyLIV OTT platform (30M+ concurrent users).
 - Personalization Strategy:** Spearhead the technical strategy and scaling of personalization engines, driving complex cross-team integrations to deliver highly tailored end-user experiences.
 - Cross-Functional Governance:** Act as the central bridge between Product and Engineering leadership, ensuring technical delivery aligns with overarching business priorities.
- Sony Pictures Networks India** May 2021 - Mar 2026

Lead Program Manager (Tech & Product)

 - Strategic OPEX & Build vs. Buy:** Managed the multi-million-dollar budget and delivery for 'Bolt' (proprietary CMS), replacing legacy vendors to achieve a 40% reduction in publishing latency and major operational savings.
 - Data Governance & Scale:** Led cross-functional squads (Legal, InfoSec, Engineering) to define technical roadmaps for US/Europe expansion, implementing robust GDPR/PII compliance frameworks.
 - Innovation Strategy:** Steered the 'Mobile Web Revamp' and 'Shorts' video initiatives, driving decisions that optimized rendering performance and increased ad-inventory monetization.
 - Architectural Modernization:** Drove the modularization of a legacy monolithic backend, decoupling and scaling dedicated microservices for Playback, Listing, and User Subscription Management.
- Walmart Global Tech** Dec 2019 - May 2021

Technical Program Manager

 - FinTech Architecture & Operational Excellence:** Led the engineering roadmap for the 'Post Payment Audit' system, partnering with Staff Engineers to redesign data pipelines for automated anomaly detection while championing DevOps/CI-CD practices - recovering multi-millions annually.
 - Retail Commerce & Platform Optimization:** Governed cross-functional delivery of in-store financial service platforms, minimizing transaction latency, accelerating release cycles, and elevating the Point-of-Sale (POS) experience.
- Conduent Inc.** Mar 2019 - Dec 2019

Business Process Manager

 - AI/ML Strategy:** Spearheaded development of NLP-based machine-learning models for customer sentiment analysis, enabling data-driven strategies to reduce churn.
 - Data Visualization:** Delivered executive dashboards (Power BI) visualizing revenue trends and operational efficiency, directly informing quarterly business reviews (QBRs).
- Intel Corporation** Jul 2016 - Mar 2019

Senior Business Analyst

 - Platform Integration:** Managed vendor relationships and delivered an integration platform handling 10,000+ daily transactions, generating \$10M in business value.
 - Big Data Analytics:** Led data-analysis initiatives using Impala and Hive, applying predictive modeling to optimize supply-chain decisions.
- Early Career** Jul 2012 - Jun 2016

Business Analyst - Odessa Technologies; Accenture

- Business analysis and delivery across enterprise software programs at Odessa Technologies (2015-2016) and Accenture (2012-2015).

EDUCATION

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| • MBA in E-Business - Annamalai University (2022) | • B.E. in Electronics & Instrumentation - Visvesvaraya Technological University (2012) |
| • PG in Big Data Analytics - Illinois Institute of Technology (2018) | |

CERTIFICATIONS

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| • PMP Certified (PMP#-3195092) | • Certified ScrumMaster - CSM (000594368) |
| • Lean Six Sigma Black Belt, KPMG (DL122024138) | • Certified Scrum Product Owner - CSPO (000594368) |
| • Lean Six Sigma Green Belt, KPMG (BG122014272) | • ITIL Certified & Practitioner (GR750213195VS) |
| • SAFe 5 DevOps Practitioner (86530983-9427) | |